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Building Mobile Applications with ScoutBuilder

Jim Desper, Product Manager,
Aether Systems, Inc.

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Aether's Vision

Mobile and Wireless

Solutions for the Enterprise.

Enabling Access to Information

Anytime—Anywhere!

Enabling Tools and Technologies

Develop



ScoutBuilder

- Application Creation
- Deployment
- Easy-to-Use
- WYSIWYG Interface

Exchange Data



ScoutSync

- Data Synchronization
- Bi-Directional
- Connectivity Options
- Multiple Device Support

Optimize Airlink



AIM

- Secure Real-Time Messaging
- Compression/ Encryption
- Device and Network Independent

Deliver Content



ScoutWeb

- Data Transformation
- Real-Time Access
- Device Independence
- Re-Use Existing Content

Manage



ScoutIT

- Device Management
- Application Management
- Software Deployment
- IT Administration

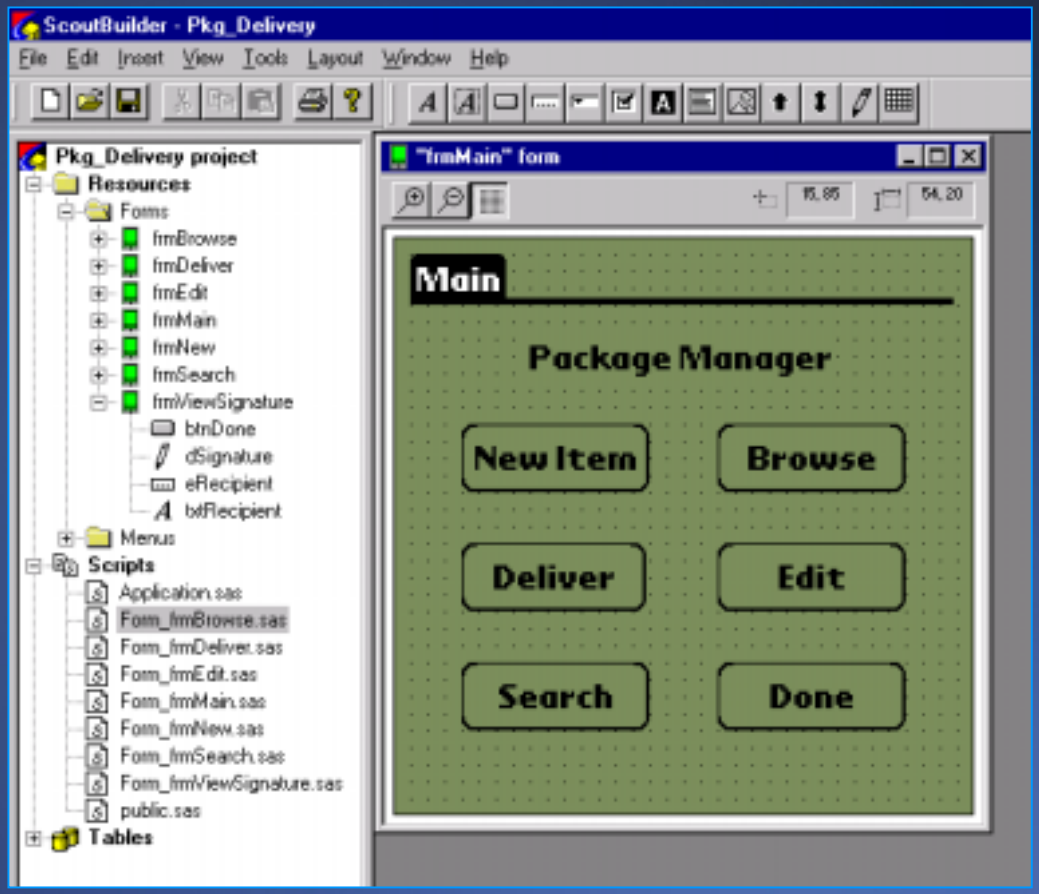
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ScoutBuilder

- Integrated Development Environment (IDE) for Palm OS®
- Forms-based point and click WYSIWYG editor
- Full featured scripting language
- ScoutBuilder runtime engine with no fee for distribution

Integrated Development Environment

- Quickly prototype applications
- Design all the visual components of an application
- Design tables and add table data
- Script program logic to tie components together



Forms

- Forms are displayed in the IDE exactly as they will look on a handheld device
- Objects can be laid out on a form for rapid prototyping, then later scripted together into a working application



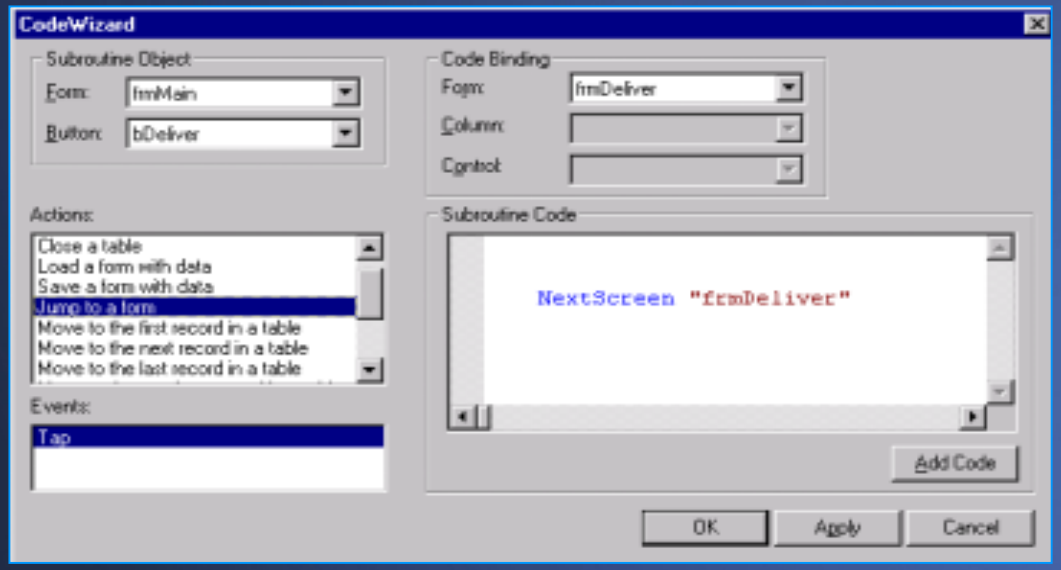
In this example, the developer created a form for accessing the latest stock price, change, and volume

Tables

- Tables can be quickly designed and modified
- ScoutBuilder allows for keyed tables, which enable faster database searching
- The Synchronization API handles record layout processes simplifying record and field access when coding ScoutSync conduits

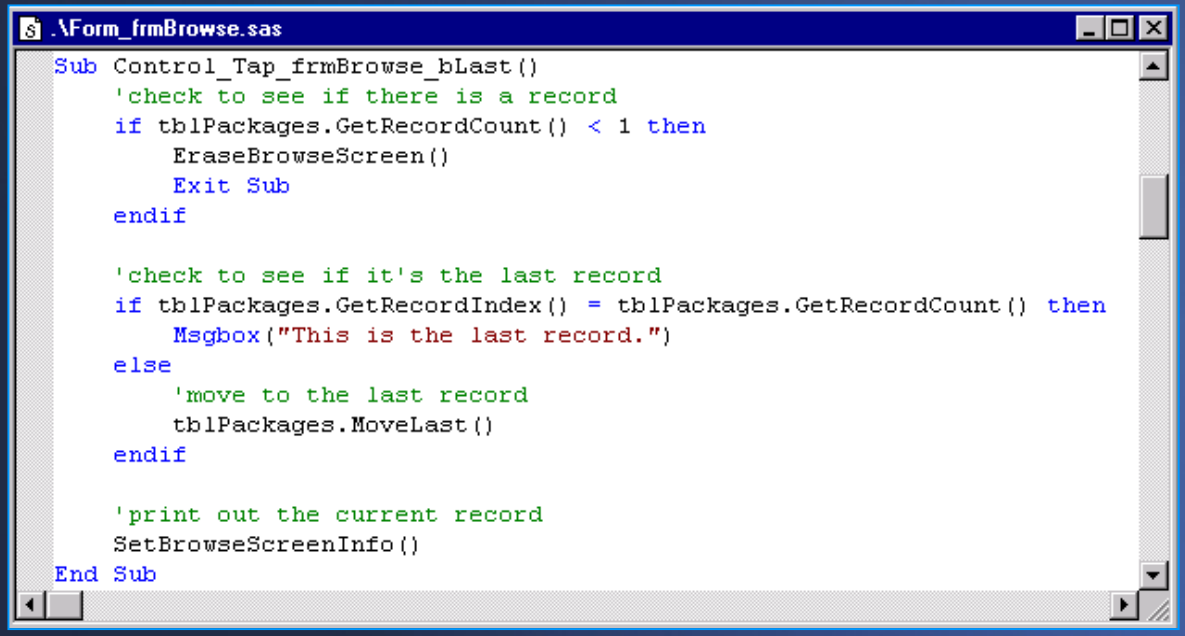
CodeWizard

- The CodeWizard enables point and click code generation
- The CodeWizard converts the developer's instructions into ScoutBuilder scripting language commands and inserts the code into the correct form-level script



Scripting Language

- Over 130 commands that direct the handling of all actions on the form
- A familiar scripting language reduces time spent learning a new language
- Complete, online scripting language reference

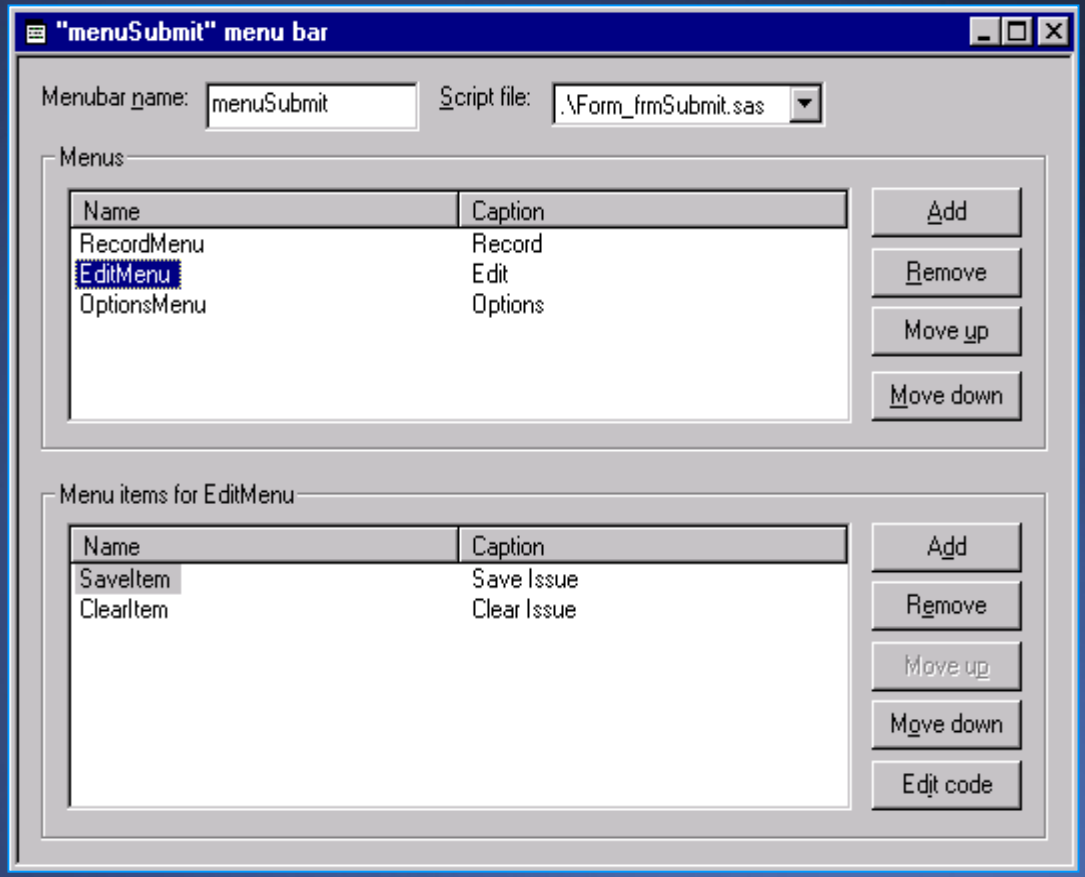


Code window for application scripting

Colors help to differentiate statement types

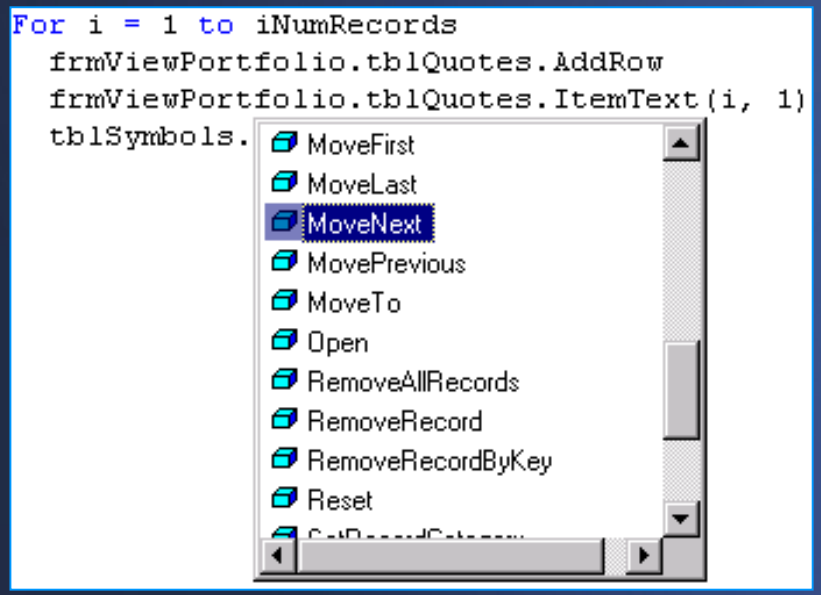
Menus

- A menu bar can be assigned to each form
- The items provide shortcuts to other forms or tasks
- ScoutBuilder menus are very flexible and enhance the functionality of the displayed form



Intellisense

- Intellisense helps to automatically complete lines of code
- Helps to speed up development and assists the less-experienced developer



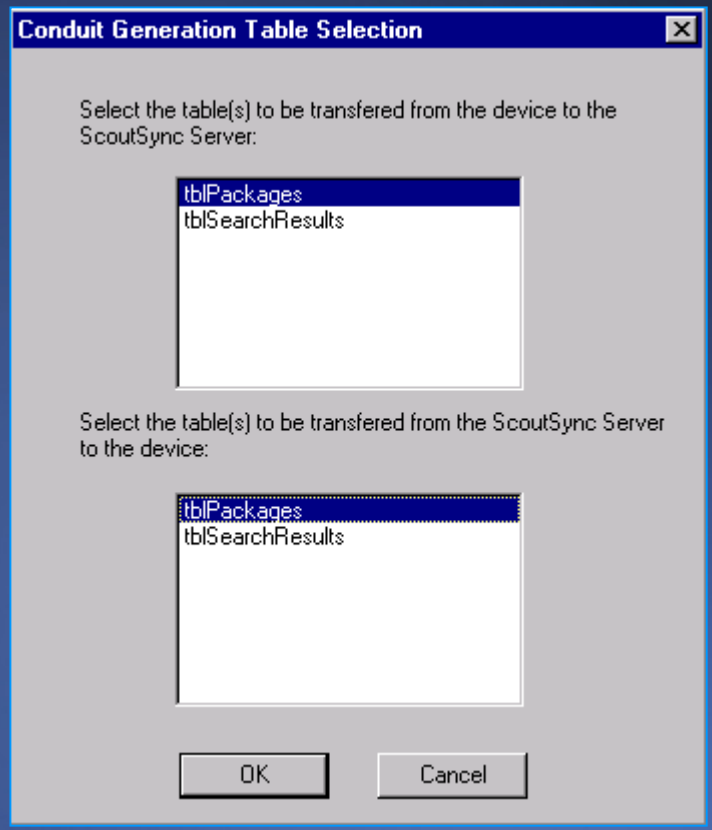
In this example, the developer began typing "tblSymbols" followed by a period and Intellisense suggested the list of available methods in the drop down box

ODBC Import

- Re-use existing table structures
- Importing tables and data rather than re-creating them
- Reproduce table structures and data accurately
- Make synchronization easier by keeping handheld table data types and field names consistent with enterprise ODBC data sources

ScoutSync / HotSync Server Conduits

- Using a wizard, developers can choose source and destination databases to update
- The developer needs to code only the actual synchronization logic
- ScoutBuilder can generate both Visual Basic and Visual C++ framework conduits



Documented and Powerful API

- The API contains over 60 methods for accessing, updating, adding, and deleting records
- Many commands use the same command name and syntax as the ScoutBuilder scripting language
- The API reference is well-documented

Syntax

```
Integer table.AddNewRecord()
```

Return values

Integer value of 1 (sbDbOK) on success and 0 (sbDbErr) on failure.

Example from Scripting Language

Syntax

```
Integer AddNewRecord()
```

Return values

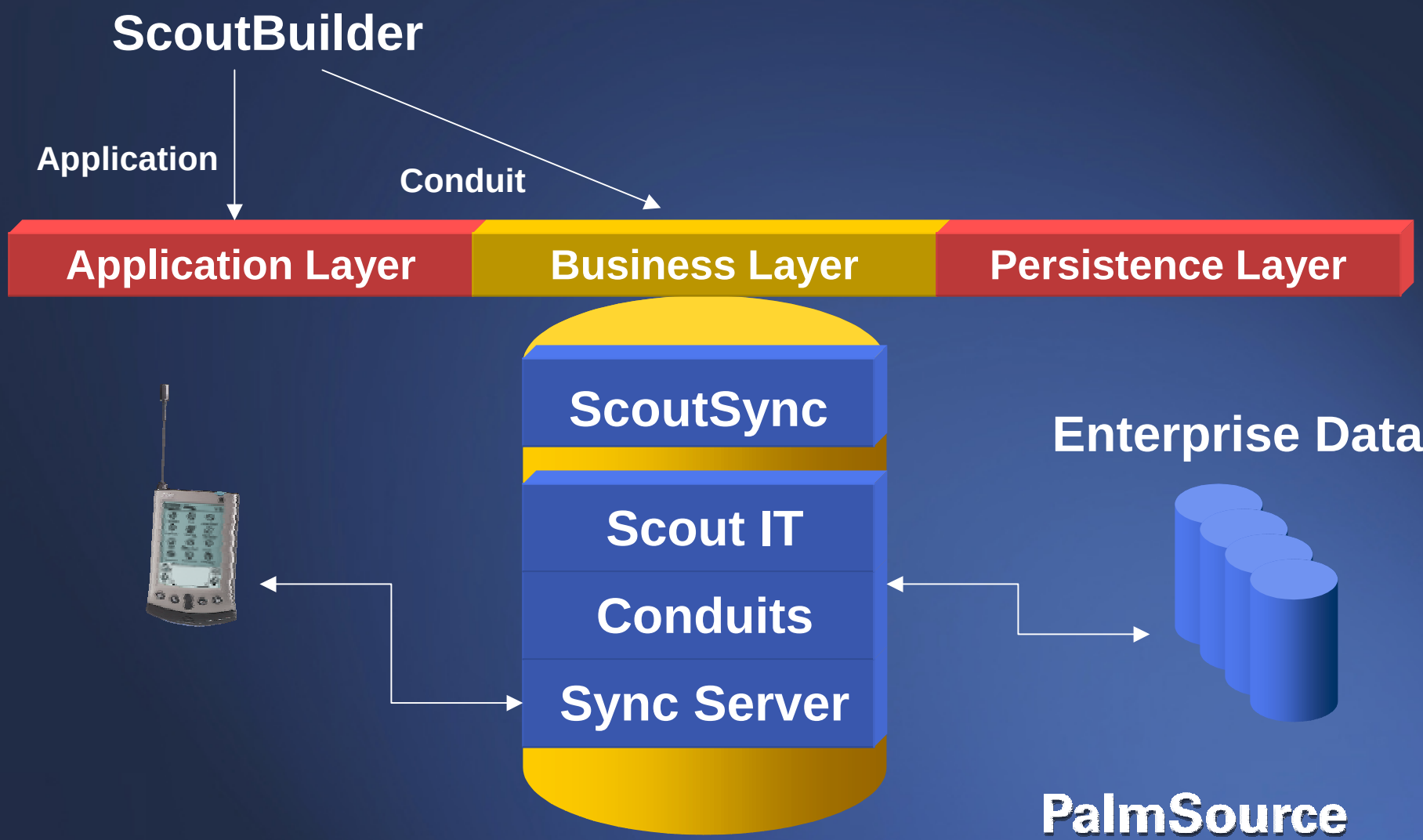
Integer value of 1 on success and 0 on failure.

Example from Synchronization API

ScoutBuilder and ScoutSync

- Complete the distributed model for mobile computing
  - Presentation Layer—built using ScoutBuilder
  - Business Layer—built using ScoutBuilder, runs within ScoutBuilder and ScoutSync
  - Persistence Layer—built by reusing existing database and database objects

ScoutBuilder and ScoutSync



Example—Package Delivery

- Allows users to scan in packages at a warehouse and collect a signature when the package is delivered
- Users can browse and search the list of packages and synchronize delivery information



Main Menu



New Item Entry



Delivery Date Selection



Package Status

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Example—Portfolio Tracker

- The Portfolio Tracker allows users to obtain stock quotes from an Internet source
- Users can get a single quote or create a portfolio that stores a list of stocks



⇐ The ScoutBuilder form for creating the stock quotes

A sample from the working application ⇒



Summary

- ScoutBuilder is a rapid application tool for developing programs for the Palm OS®
- Many built-in features that accelerate the application development effort
- Very powerful, easy to learn scripting language
- Organizations deploying a ScoutBuilder solution can distribute the runtime engine free of charge


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